Preventing Online Child Abuse: Why Current Interventions Fail

Millions of searches each year target child sexual abuse material. Conventional warning banners fail to prevent harm, while surveillance fears prevent people from seeking help to stop.



1. The Habituation Trap

Behind every illicit search is a real child at risk of ongoing abuse. Yet existing platform deterrents rely on static banners that sit passively alongside search results. Repeating identical criminal threats creates rapid habituation — users scroll past without stopping.

0% Detectable Change

The 140-day Ahmia trial (3.1M warnings) proved that static banners produce no reduction in search behavior.



2. The 73.9% Pre-Contact Drop-Off

Large-scale research shows about half of individuals first encountered child abuse material accidentally, and many want to stop. However, they abandon helplines due to acute terror of police arrest, loss of anonymity, and not knowing what to say.

73.9% Abandon Support

Nearly 3 in 4 individuals who find a prevention helpline abandon before calling due to fear and stigma.



3. The Enforcement & Privacy Dilemma

Aggressive punitive blocks drive users into encrypted networks and Tor where no help exists. Meanwhile, small long-tail forums refuse heavy moderation tools that harvest user data, IP addresses, or create legal privacy liabilities.

Pushed Underground

Punitive blocks without support pathways drive illicit demand underground, leaving children unprotected.

The Imperative: Stop harm before it starts by replacing passive warnings with an active, confidential door to help.

A Door, Not a Sign. And the Wall is Glass.

Doorway actively intercepts harm at the point of search, replacing ignored banners with de-escalating behavioral pathways and verifiable zero-PII privacy.

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1. The Shift (Anti-Habituation)

Instead of a static banner, Doorway dynamically transforms across 5 progressive shapes that break the search cycle:

#1	**The Gate**	Pauses results; protects children; Quick Exit
#2	**The Fork**	6 honest paths turning impulse to choice
#3	**The Wave**	Clinical 90s urge-surfing & coping plans
#4	**The Hallway**	Answers 3 fears; pre-scripted lines
#5	**Open Door**	Non-punitive presence; path to help remains

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2. The Glass Door (Zero-PII)

People will only seek help if they trust they won't be trapped. Privacy is guaranteed by construction: strictly refuses search terms, IP addresses, cookies, and device fingerprints.

```
{
  "i": "inst_demo0001", // verified platform install
  "f": "wave", // shape shown (no query text)
  "o": "clicked_help", // outcome event
  "r": "prevention_line",// routing service
  "e": "3", "b": 16 // exposure bucket & hour
}
```

✓ Auditable directly in browser F12 DevTools
✓ 1-click localStorage wipe in the widget

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3. The Desk (Operator Adoption)

Protects children by driving voluntary adoption across long-tail platforms where abuse content often spreads:

- **The Open Door Ladder:** 5 checkable criteria earning a verifiable public badge (EU DSA compliance audit-ready).
- **k-Anonymity (k ≥ 10):** Small forum metrics below 10 are hidden to guarantee zero user re-identification.
- **Stepped-Wedge Evaluation:** Scientifically evaluates Gate vs. Banner without tracking individuals.

3-Line Integration

Installs in under 15 minutes on any forum or search engine without backend modifications.